

A FREE GUIDE FROM NEXT ERA TRAVEL

The Honeymoon Planning Guide

Choose by how you want to feel, not by the photos.

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Your honeymoon should not feel like another trip you planned while exhausted.

By the time the wedding is over, most couples have made hundreds of decisions. The honeymoon is the one trip that is meant to be easy, and it often ends up as the last item on a long list.

This guide helps you plan it in a calmer order. First how you want to feel, then the kind of place that supports it, then the details that make it feel personal and effortless.

> **How to use this guide.** Fill in the first page together, ideally before you start browsing. Then use the questions and checklists to compare options and narrow them to the right one.

WHAT IS INSIDE

- ✓ Five questions to answer before you choose a place
- ✓ Four honeymoon styles and who each suits
- ✓ Timing, with the wedding and without it
- ✓ The paperwork that is easy to miss
- ✓ Twelve questions to ask every resort
- ✓ The small details that feel romantic
- ✓ Mistakes I see most often

STEP ONE

Start with how you want to feel.

Write your answers down before you search. They are the filter for every choice that follows.

1. **What do you need most?** Rest, adventure, time alone, a celebration, or a little of each. Be honest about how tired you will be after the wedding.
2. **What pace feels good?** Nothing planned at all, one special thing a day, or a full itinerary with a place to rest at night.
3. **How private do you want it?** Quiet and secluded, or a resort with energy, dining, and other guests around.
4. **How far and how long?** Consider flight time, connections, and the days you actually have. A long journey can eat the first two days of a short trip.
5. **What would make it unforgettable?** A moment, a meal, a view, a place with meaning to you both. Name one thing you do not want to miss.

> **Why this order matters.** Resorts look similar in photos and feel very different in person. When you know the feeling first, most options rule themselves out.

STEP TWO

Four honeymoon styles.

Most honeymoons fall into one of these. Many couples blend two.

ALL INCLUSIVE AND EASY

Food, drinks, and activities in one place, so nothing needs deciding once you arrive. Good for rest, simplicity, and couples who want everything handled.

PRIVATE AND SECLUDED

Villas, overwater bungalows, or small boutique stays. Quiet, personal, and often more about the setting and service than the activities.

ADVENTURE AND EXPLORING

Moving between places, with food, culture, and scenery. Rewarding, but plan some real rest into the schedule.

TWO PLACES, ONE TRIP

A few days of exploring followed by a few days of rest, or the reverse. Often the best balance, with one move rather than many.

THINGS TO COMPARE FOR YOUR OWN SITUATION

- ✓ Weather and season for the place and the dates you have
- ✓ Flight time and the easiest route
- ✓ What kind of room you would be happy to come back to every evening

> **A note from me.** The wrong resort changes the whole emotional experience of a trip. The same island can feel restful at one property and busy at another.

STEP THREE

Timing, with the wedding and without it.

When to go matters as much as where. Think about your energy as well as the calendar.

- ✓ **Leave a buffer after the wedding.** Many couples arrive tired. A day to settle, or a start a few days later, can feel much better.
- ✓ **Check the season.** Weather and crowds change by month, and hurricane season affects much of the Caribbean and parts of Mexico.

WORTH KNOWING

The paperwork that is easy to miss.

- ✓ **Names must match.** Your reservation and flights need to match the name on your passport. If you are changing your name, speak with me before booking so nothing is mismatched.
- ✓ **Check passports early.** Some countries require several months of validity. Renewals take time.
- ✓ **Confirm entry requirements.** Visas and other rules differ by destination and change, so use official sources.
- ✓ **Think about travel protection.** Ask what is covered before you buy.

STEP FOUR

Twelve questions to ask every resort.

Ask the same questions of each property so you can compare honestly.

- [ ] What room categories are there, and which do couples on a honeymoon most often choose?
- [ ] What is included, and what costs extra, such as dining, drinks, spa, and activities?
- [ ] How large is the property, and how far are the rooms from the beach, pool, and restaurants?
- [ ] Is the resort adults only, or are there families and children on site?
- [ ] How private are the pool and beach areas, and how busy do they get in the season we are going?
- [ ] Which restaurants need reservations, and how far ahead can we book?
- [ ] Do you offer honeymoon perks, a welcome gesture, or a private dinner?
- [ ] What is the transfer from the airport, how long does it take, and is it included?
- [ ] What are the spa and activity options, and what is the best way to book them?
- [ ] What is the weather like for our dates, and what is the plan if it changes?
- [ ] What are the payment schedule and the change and cancellation terms?
- [ ] Who will be our contact before we arrive and while we are there?

STEP FIVE

The small details that feel romantic.

The honeymoons people remember are rarely about one big thing. They are about a handful of details done well.

- ✓ **Tell the resort you are on your honeymoon.** Many properties add touches when they know, from room set up to a welcome gesture.
- ✓ **Choose the room, not only the resort.** View, privacy, and layout shape how the trip feels every morning and evening.
- ✓ **Plan one special evening.** A private dinner, a sunset, or a moment that is just for the two of you. Book it early.
- ✓ **Leave space.** A day with nothing planned is often the one couples enjoy most.
- ✓ **Make arrival easy.** A smooth transfer and an early check in request can set the tone for the whole trip.
- ✓ **Let someone else handle the logistics.** The less you manage, the more present you are.

THE MISTAKES I SEE MOST OFTEN

- ✓ Choosing from the photos
- ✓ Booking the cheapest room, then wanting more privacy
- ✓ Planning too much and ending up tired
- ✓ Leaving the honeymoon until the last minute
- ✓ Not checking that names and passports match

YOUR NEXT STEP

If you would rather not plan it alone.

This guide is a good start. Some couples take it from here and plan beautifully on their own. Others want someone to listen, narrow the options, and handle the details, so the honeymoon feels as good as the day before it.

That is the work I do. We begin with a consultation, where I listen to how you want to feel and what has mattered most to you both. Your planning investment is quoted after our conversation, so there are no surprises.

Christine Joy

Next Era Travel
Planning honeymoons and destination weddings

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This guide is general information to help you plan. Details, inclusions, and requirements change, so always confirm current information with official sources and your travel provider before you book.